Writing

1 AN INFORMAL EMAIL

From: Anna
To: johnstons586@gmail.com
Subject: News!

Hi Sue,

Sorry that I havent been in touch for a while, but I've been ill. I got flu last week and I had a temprature of 39°C, so I've been in bed since four days. I'm feeling a bit better today, so I've been catching up on my emails. Luckly, my classes at university don't start till next week.

How are you? What have you been doing? Anything exciting. Here everyone are fine (apart from me and my flu!). My brother Ian has just started his new job with a software-company – I think I told you about it when I last wrote – anyway, so far, he's really been enjoying it. How are your family? I hope their well.

I have some good news – I'm going to a conference in your town in may, from 16th to 20th. Could you recomend a hotel where I could stay, in the centre of town? It needs to be somewhere not too expensive because the university is paying. I'll have a free half-day for siteseeing. Do you think you'll be able show me around? That would be great.

Well, that's all for now. Please give my regards to your parents.

Hope to hear from you soon.

Take care,

Anna

PS Please reply to this email address. I've stopped using the old Yahoo one.

Beginning an informal email
When you are writing an informal email, it is more usual to start with *Hi* than with *Dear*.

a Read the email from Anna. It has 12 highlighted mistakes – four grammar or vocabulary, four punctuation, and four spelling. With a partner, decide what kind of mistake each one is and correct it.

haven't
temperature
for
Luckily
Anything exciting?
is
software company
they're
May
recommend
sightseeing
to show

b Read Anna's email again and find phrases that mean…

emailed, messaged, or phoned
reading and replying to
Have you been doing anything fun?
I don't have any more news.
send my best wishes to

c You're going to answer Anna's email. Look at the **Useful language** expressions and try to complete them.

Useful language: an informal email

Opening expressions
Thanks [1] for *your email / letter.*
It was great [2] to *hear from you.*
Sorry that I haven't been in touch for a while. / Sorry for [3] not *writing earlier.*
I [4] hope *you and your family are well.*

Responding to news
Glad to [5] hear *that you're all well.*
Sorry [6] to *hear about your exam results.*
Good [7] luck *with the new job.*
Hope you [8] get *better soon.*

Closing expressions
Anyway, / Well, that's all [9] for *now.*
[10] Give *my regards (love) to…*
Hope to hear from you soon. / Looking [11] forward *to hearing from you soon.*
Take [12] care */ (Lots of) love*
[13] Best *wishes / Regards*

Something you forgot and want to add
[14] PS *Don't forget to send me the photos you promised.*

d **Plan** the content of your email.

1 Underline the questions in the email that Anna wants you to answer.
2 Underline other places in the email where you think you need to respond, e.g. *I've been ill.*
3 Think about how to respond to each of the things you've underlined.

e **Write** 140–190 words, in two or three paragraphs. Use informal language (contractions, etc.), and expressions from **Useful language**.

f **Check** your email for mistakes (grammar, punctuation, and spelling).

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